How to build a site template

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Slides:

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Today…

- What's a site template? 🤔
- How do you make one? 🛠️
- Where do we go from here? 🏃

What we're solving

- 👎 You have to start from (nearly) scratch
- 👎 Finding the right modules and configuring them is tricky
- 👎 Making a beautiful site is hard and/or expensive

What is a site template?

👉 A recipe for a mostly-finished website. 👈

- All functionality pre-configured
- Polished look and feel
- Realistic default content (landing pages, articles, tax. terms, media…) aimed at specific use case(s)
- **Umami** was an early implementation of this concept

Site templates are recipes

- Choose one and apply once, at the start of a project
- Don't worry about composability or update path
- Focus on **default content** and **presentation**
- Drupal CMS 2 is optimized for site templates

Recap

- Site templates are one-off recipes that focus on content and presentation
- Drupal CMS is the optimal platform for them
- 👉 A site template should get you **95% of the way** to a finished site.

To build a site template:

1. 💧 Start with Drupal CMS
2. 🖌️ Build a site you're proud of
3. 📦 Export as a recipe
4. 🌐 Publish it! (optional)

👉 Building a site == making a site template

1. Start with the basics

- Drupal CMS gives you everything you need
- Until D11.3, patch core with https://tinyurl.com/wcpyj3j2 for content export
- If not using Drupal CMS:

```
composer require drupal/drupal_cms_helper
```

👆 These are **recommendations**, not rules.

2. Build a nice site

- Consider the target audience and use case
- Configure however you like, create content: it's just normal site building!
- Use any page building tool you want
  - Ideal: Canvas all the things 😍
  - Reality: create a custom theme if you need one 😐

3. Export a recipe

- `drush site:export --destination=../recipes/my_template`
- Customize `recipe.yml` as desired
- Optional: add `screenshot.webp` (632x304, this may change)
- To test: `drush si -y /path/to/drupal/recipes/my_template`

4. Publish it!

- Create a **general project** on drupal.org
- If you have a custom theme, publish it as a separate project
- Scaffolding is provided by Drupal CMS
- It is now 🍺 o'clock. 🎉

* Please *don't* call it "Drupal CMS"! 🙏 🙏 🙏

An example…

Byte, the first site template for Drupal CMS:

https://git.drupalcode.org/project/byte

…and a live demo 😱

Where we go next…

- More site templates (and examples)!
- Documented best practices
- More and better tooling… 🚀 💪 🔧
  - bulk content export?
  - recipe generator?
  - export from UI?
  - choose any template from the installer?
  - moar Canvas power?

Further resources

- Site template RFC
- Recipes Initiative documentation
- Slack:
  - #drupal-cms-development
  - #drupal-cms-templates
  - #recipes
- This deck: https://tinyurl.com/26yzck9u or

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ASK ME STUFF

@phenaproxima

not on teh socials but I'm probably in the contribution room

thanks for listening!